

Your SAM.gov Registration

This guide helps you register your business in [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov), which is the first mandatory step for winning federal contracts.

What it is. [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) is the official government database for all federal contractors. It's where you get your Unique Entity Identifier (UEI), declare your business size, and list any set-aside statuses you qualify for, like Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business. Agencies use this information to find eligible companies and confirm you're ready to do business.

When to use it. You need to finish your [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) registration before you can bid on any federal work. Think of it as getting your entry ticket. It's the absolute first thing to do once you decide to pursue government contracts.

How to use it.

- Start with the '[SAM.gov](#) Registration Walkthrough' to understand each step. It'll show you the whole process.
- Use the 'Pre-Registration Checklist' to gather all your required documents before you begin. This helps avoid delays.
- Open the 'NAICS Code Picker' to select your primary and secondary codes. These codes are critical; they often determine around 80% of the contract opportunities you'll see.
- Finally, use the 'Annual Renewal Kit' to schedule your yearly renewal. Mark it on your calendar now.

Watch out for. The biggest mistake first-timers make is letting their [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) registration expire. A lapsed registration will get your bid tossed, no exceptions.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/sam-registration> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/certifications> (Certification Eligibility)